

Pratibha Gautam

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EDUCATION

Harvard University, T.H. Chan School of Public Health, Boston, MA May 2023
Master of Science (SM) in Global Health and Population; Concentration in Health Economics
Thesis: Feeding Minds and Fueling Futures: An Economic Evaluation of School Feeding Programs in Malawi

University of Massachusetts Lowell, Lowell, MA May 2020
Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Economics and Psychology, Honors
Thesis: HIV Infections and Nightlight Luminosity

WORK EXPERIENCE

Human Development Report Office, UNDP, New York, NY Feb 2024 – Feb 2026
Research Consultant

- Co-authored and contributed original research and analytical framing to three consecutive UNDP Human Development Reports (HDR) (2024, 2025, and forthcoming 2026) - UNDP's flagship global advocacy publication used by policymakers and partners worldwide - analyzing household surveys and global development datasets to examine emerging inequalities and their implications for human development.
- Wrote advocacy and briefing materials, concept notes (including for UNDP's Wellbeing Symposium), background papers, and expert-consultation summaries, and fact-checked the 2024 Multidimensional Poverty Index report; these written inputs fed into office reports, presentations, and other UN publications beyond the flagship HDR.

Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health, Boston, MA Jun 2023 – Dec 2023
Research Assistant

- Co-authored a manuscript evaluating the impact of digitizing payments to polio campaign workers across Côte d'Ivoire, Liberia, and the Republic of Congo, a WHO pilot supported by the Gates Foundation.
- Analyzed survey responses to assess how digitized payments related to timeliness, worker satisfaction, and motivation, finding that timely digital payments were associated with better payment experiences and higher salary satisfaction across the three countries; factors important for vaccinator morale and the effective delivery of polio campaigns.

Center for Global Development, Washington, D.C. Feb 2023 – May 2023
Research Collaborator

- Co-authored and published a policy paper on "best-buy" surveillance investments for pandemic preparedness (respiratory infections), synthesizing global evidence to guide strategic investment decisions.
- Presented key findings to stakeholders in a roundtable, identifying cost and effectiveness gaps to inform future pandemic preparedness and response efforts.

Brigham & Women's Hospital, Boston, MA Mar 2022 – Oct 2023
Research Assistant

- Led data collection, quantitative and qualitative analysis, and manuscript preparation for health-systems strengthening initiatives in low- and middle-income countries, contributing to three peer-reviewed publications spanning hospital quality improvement, clinical-skills strengthening, and disease burden in low-resource settings.

- Workstreams included, analyzing Minimum Service Standards survey data to assess district-hospital readiness in Nepal; developed a white paper with the Nick Simons Institute to present data-driven recommendations to the Ministry of Health, informing Nepal's National Hospital Standardization System, and co-authored a resulting publication on the assessment tool and hospital strengthening program in *The Lancet Regional Health – Southeast Asia*.

Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health, Boston, MA

Feb 2022 – Mar 2023

Research Assistant

- Developed the methodological foundation for evaluating the value-for-money of school feeding programs (SFPs) for primary-school children (ages 6–12) by building an Extended Cost-Effectiveness Analysis model that quantified multi-sectoral returns across health, education, and social protection, and estimated distributional impacts using R and Monte Carlo simulations.
- Presented findings to the Malawi Government and multilateral stakeholders, advocating for the expansion of SFPs based on demonstrated high value for money; work contributed to a conceptual publication and forthcoming methodological papers on school meal impacts.

Social Changemakers & Innovators, Kathmandu, Nepal

Sep 2020 – Mar 2022

Research Collaborator

- Designed and analyzed surveys assessing the short- and long-term impacts of COVID-19 on pregnant and lactating mothers, children, and urban-poor households; presented findings to local government to inform response to the pandemic's disproportionate impact on vulnerable populations.

Curta Consulting, Seattle, WA

Jun 2020 – Jul 2021

Research Analyst

- Conducted health economics analyses (claims data, clinical-trial data, literature) supporting cost-effectiveness, indirect-cost, and budget-impact models for market access, contributing to FDA approval of PADCEV and Ruxolitinib.
- Synthesized technical information into written studies, model descriptions, and PowerPoint presentations for biopharmaceutical and biotechnology clients.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Pokhrel R, Knoble A, **Gautam P**, Shah MK, Paudel P, Amatya A, Upadhyaya MK, Rajbhandari R. Minimum service standards assessment tool and the hospital strengthening program: a novel first step towards the quality improvement of Nepal's national hospital system. *The Lancet Regional Health – Southeast Asia*. 2025 Mar 1;34.
- Verguet S, **Gautam P**, Ali I, Husain A, Meyer S, Burbano C, Lloyd-Evans E, Coco M, Mphangwe M, Saka A, Zelalem M. Investing in school systems: conceptualising returns on investment across the health, education and social protection sectors. *BMJ Global Health*. 2023 Dec 1;8(12):e012545.
- Thapa R, Nikolli K, McMahon D, Blakemore S, Tamang S, Bhatta S, **Gautam P**, Shrestha R, Rajbhandari R. Novel on-site follow-up and enhancement program (FEP) improves knowledge, clinical skills and enabling environment of skilled birth attendants in Nepal. *PLoS ONE*. 2023 Aug 22;18(8):e0285653.
- Fan VY, Smitham E, Regan L, **Gautam P**, Norheim O, Guzman J, Glassman A. Strategic Investment in Surveillance for Pandemic Preparedness: Rapid Review and Roundtable Discussion. *CGD Policy Papers*. 2023 Jun;(298).
- **Gautam P**, Li BG. HIV infections and nightlight luminosity. *Economics Letters*. 2021 Jul 1;204:109887.